

chilling sensations to run up and down the spine. Sometimes, old memories from past lives surface, but vanish as quickly as they came, leaving only emotional imprints behind that affect the Kithain.

A mysterious aspect of the Near Dreaming is its effects on comatose, or deeply sleeping, mortals that occasionally appear as living shadows in dream realms or on trods. While they remain unable to affect anything, they're able to hold conversations with chimera and fae, in addition to being able to learn about the chimerical existence. After waking up they (usually) don't remember anything, but still manage to hang on to the emotions of having regained something fantastic.

The Firchlís

The Autumn Realm's proximity sometimes inflicts powerful mutations on the Near Dreaming. Kithain describe the effect as rippling waves morphing the environment, as well as the destinations and nature of trods. Changelings call these occurrences the *Firchlís*, and while they're personally immune to its effects, it makes traveling through the Dreaming both more dangerous and exciting. While homesteads have proven quite resilient to the *Firchlís*, most likely due to permanent changeling presence, furniture and appearances continuously change, even if not drastically.

It should be said that the rippling mutations are not just a source of horrible effects. Since the Resurgence, changelings discovered a few lost freeholds in the Near Dreaming because of the constant changes. Scholars consider these exceptional, since they have no trods that connect them to the mundane world, or even anchors to keep them stable. Despite this, the balefires burn brightly and the locations shield those inside from the mutating effects that the *Firchlís* impose, and what's even stranger is that for the duration of the stay in such freeholds, Kithain cease to be purified from Banality.

Example location: The Seas of Dream

Vast oceans in the Near Dreaming hides secrets in their depths. Ancient creatures sleep at the bottom, waiting for the right time to rise again. The Seas of Dream are the reflections of many nautical dreams over the years. Traveling on water trods by using ships brings explorers from mystical islands and ancient gateways into deeper areas of the Dreaming. Due to their connection to water, selkies are the first to say that seas can be merciless, while containing endless possibilities.



Example: Firchlís Effect

The meadow full of serene beauty under the sunlit sky immediately mutates into a twisted, dark forest. Songs of the legendary sirens call out to travelers to join the singers in their garden of shadows, and if a changeling follows, he finds himself at the mercy of Thallain hunting for Tuathan descendants or feral chimera.

